

The Paper Project

Paper is the truest form of a document, physical, permanent, and universally readable. ‘The Paper Project’ brings together Markdown and LaTeX with diagrams, formulae, and rich formatting and renders the result as a PDF.

Overview

`paper` takes a Markdown file and renders it as a styled PDF via a Docker container. It handles:

- Custom LaTeX template with section-aware headers and page numbers
- Emoji rendering (unicode → SVG via twemoji)
- Mermaid diagrams (rendered via headless Chrome)
- Toggles for page numbers and section page breaks

Requirements

- Docker
- The `paper:latest` image built from this directory

```
docker build -t paper:latest .
```

Usage

```
paper <file.md> [options]
```

Option	Description
<code>--pages=yes</code>	Show page numbers (default)
<code>--pages=no</code>	Hide page numbers
<code>--continuous</code>	No page break between sections
<code>-v, --verbose</code>	Print commands as they run

After the PDF is generated it opens automatically. You are then prompted whether to keep or delete it.

Examples

```
# Basic
paper report.md

# No page numbers
paper report.md --pages=no

# No section breaks, no page numbers
paper report.md --continuous --pages=no
```

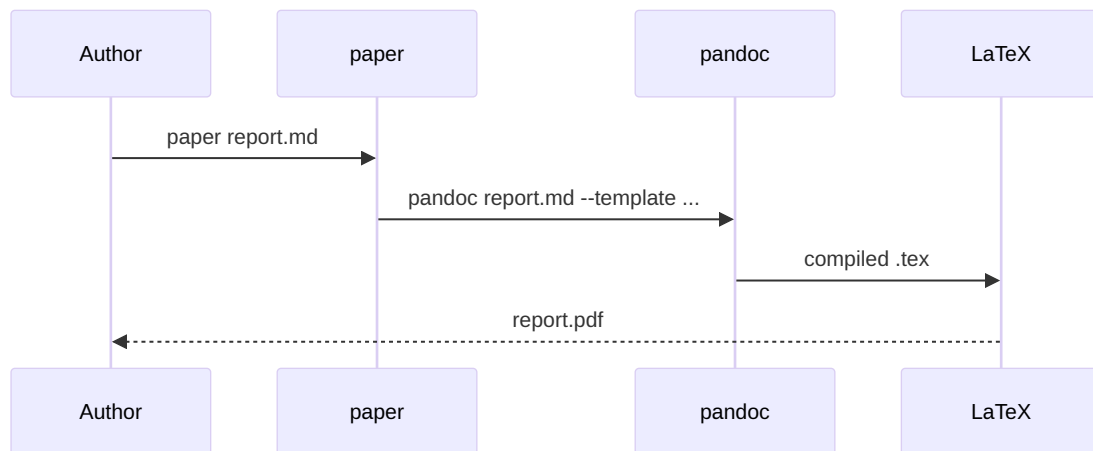
Mermaid diagrams

Mermaid code blocks are rendered as diagrams in the PDF.

```

```mermaid
graph TD
 A[Write Markdown] --> B[Run paper]
 B --> C{Success?}
 C -- Yes --> D[Open PDF]
 C -- No --> E[Fix errors]
 E --> B
```

```



Front matter variables

Set these in your document's YAML front matter to control layout:

```

---
title: My Report
author: Your Name
date: 2026-06-13
continuous-pages: true    # no page breaks between sections
no-page-numbers: true     # hide page numbers
---

```

Project structure

```

paper/
├── Dockerfile           # pandoc + Chrome + node environment
├── template.tex         # custom LaTeX template
├── emoji_filter.js      # pandoc filter: unicode emoji → SVG
├── pandoc-emoji-filter.js # preprocessor: prepares emoji for filter
├── paper               # CLI script (symlinked from dotfiles/scripts/paper)
└── package.json        # node dependencies (mermaid-filter, pandoc-filter)

```